

Organise your contacts better using the features in Plus!

Who's Added You?

To see who has added you to their contacts list, simply go to **Tools > Options > Privacy**, and then click **View**.

Think Outside The Contact List

To send an instant message to someone who is not on your contact list, right-click on the MSN Messenger icon in the system tray, click 'Send an instant message', and then choose the 'Other' tab. Here you can enter the e-mail address of the person you want to message.

To prevent other people from sending you messages this way, go to **Tools > Options > Privacy**, and tick 'Only people on my Allow list can see my status and send me messages'.

View By E-mail Address

People use nicknames such as "Look who's

here" or things like that, which is what you see when you log in to Messenger. Since people change these nicknames often, you might not know who a contact is until you run the mouse over the nickname (the display name). If this is an annoyance, you can view all your contacts by their e-mail address. To do this, go to **Contacts > Manage Contacts > View Contacts by**, and select **E-mail address**.

Lots Of Emoticons—Free

When you want to send an emoticon in a message, you typically click on the smiley in the conversation window to get more smileys. There are many more emoticons that you can use, each with its keyboard shortcut. For a list of all emoticons available for various versions of Messenger, look at <http://www.bigblueball.com/im/msn/msn-emoticons.asp>

No More Tabs On The Left

If you find the tabs to the left of the contact list annoying, you can turn them off. They are not much use anyway. Simply go to **Tools > Options > Privacy**, and tick 'This is a shared computer so don't display my tabs'.

Plus!

Plus! is a freeware add-on for MSN Messenger. It offers various Messenger tweaks, advanced logging, enhanced notifications, security and privacy control, etc. You can get it

at <http://www.msgplus.net/>, or install it from the DVD. If you want a full list of the enhancements that Plus! offers, go to <http://www.msgplus.net/features.php>.

Log Your Chats

To keep a log of all your conversations so you can retrieve them later, you can go to **Tools > Options**, click on the **Messages** tab, and tick 'Automatically keep a history of my conversations.'

Turn Emoticons Off/On

You can choose whether or not to display emoticons and/or custom emoticons in the messages you receive. Simply go to **Tools > Options**, go to the **Messages** tab, and tick or untick 'Show emoticons...' and/or 'Show custom emoticons...'

Yahoo! Messenger

Yahoo! Messenger—The Latest Version

The latest version of Yahoo! Messenger is a significant improvement over previous versions. Go to <http://messenger.yahoo.com/> to download it, and to see what's new. You can find the current latest version on the DVD accompanying this issue.

New Mail Alert

To be alerted in Yahoo! Messenger whenever you receive new mail in your Yahoo! account, do the following: Select **Login > Preferences**. Go to the **Alerts and Sounds** category. Under 'Alert me when:', highlight 'I receive a mail message'. Select the desired notification options under 'Alert me by:', and click **OK**.

Bet You Didn't Know

Disable Windows Messenger

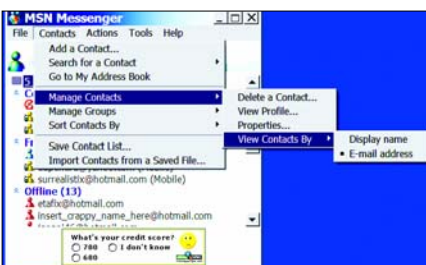
Windows Messenger automatically loads up when you start your XP computer. It also starts up at certain other events. To prevent it from loading at startup, or at any other event, do the following: Go to **Start > Run**. Type in "GPEDIT.MSC". In the window that comes up, navigate to **Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Windows Components > Windows Messenger**. Here, you will see 'Do not allow Windows Messenger to be run' and 'Do not automatically start Windows Messenger initially.' Go to each of them and enable them. Close the Group Policy window, and you're done.

All The Smileys You Want

Want to know about all the smileys you can use in Yahoo! Messenger, along with their keyboard shortcuts? Point your browser to <http://www.bigblueball.com/IM/Yahoo/yahoosmileys.asp>

YEmote2

Download it from <http://www.camgrab.tk/>. YEmote2 adds several interesting features to Yahoo! Messenger, such as advanced Webcam capture, easy smileys selection, advanced message archive viewer, an auto-reply feature, and much more. Go to <http://www.andy.w2s.co.uk/yahoo/YEmotePlus/index.htm> for more on YEmote2.



In MSN Messenger, you can choose to view contacts either by nickname or by e-mail address



Nokia, Samsung, Sony-Ericsson, or...
Who will reign the Cell Phone Kingdom?

Find out India's top tech products of 2004 across
28 categories in the Digit December issue



Digit Zero1 Awards